



Spotify: The Power-User Paradox

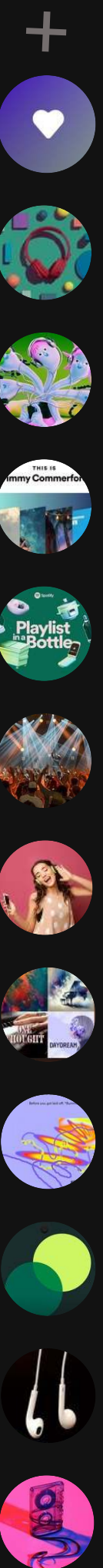
Artist - Saugaat Gupta

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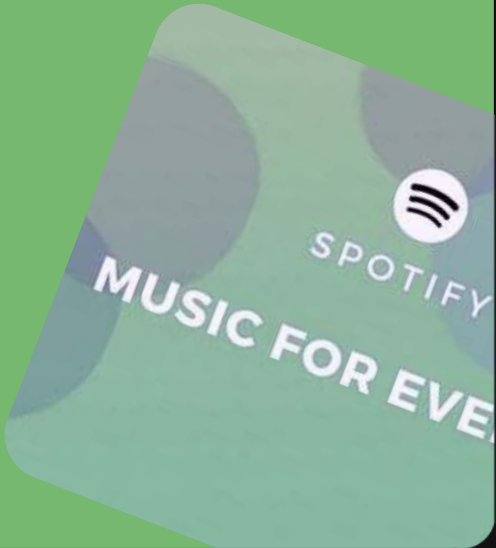
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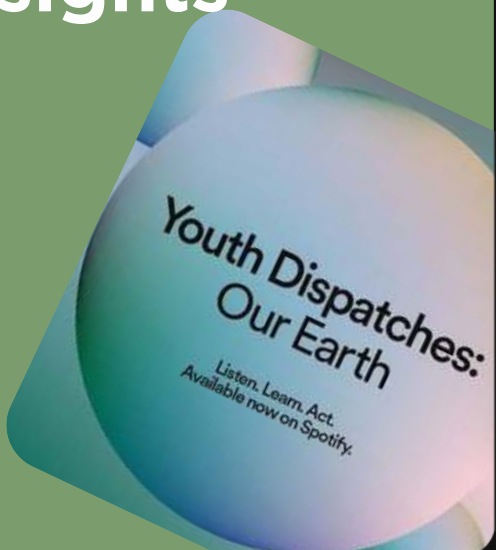
Personas & Prioritized Features



Roadmap & Execution Plan



Additional Insights & Trade-offs



Final Reflection & Business Impact



COMPANY OVERVIEW

Spotify is a digital music streaming service that provides instant access to its vast online library of manifold music genres, podcasts and audiobooks.

It was launched in 2008 by Swedish entrepreneurs Daniel EK and Martin Lorentzon.



On an average, a user spends 2.5 hours on this platform.



More than 35% of Spotify users are under 24 years old.



More than 60,000 tracks are updated every day.

MUSIC VS PODCAST ENGAGEMENT



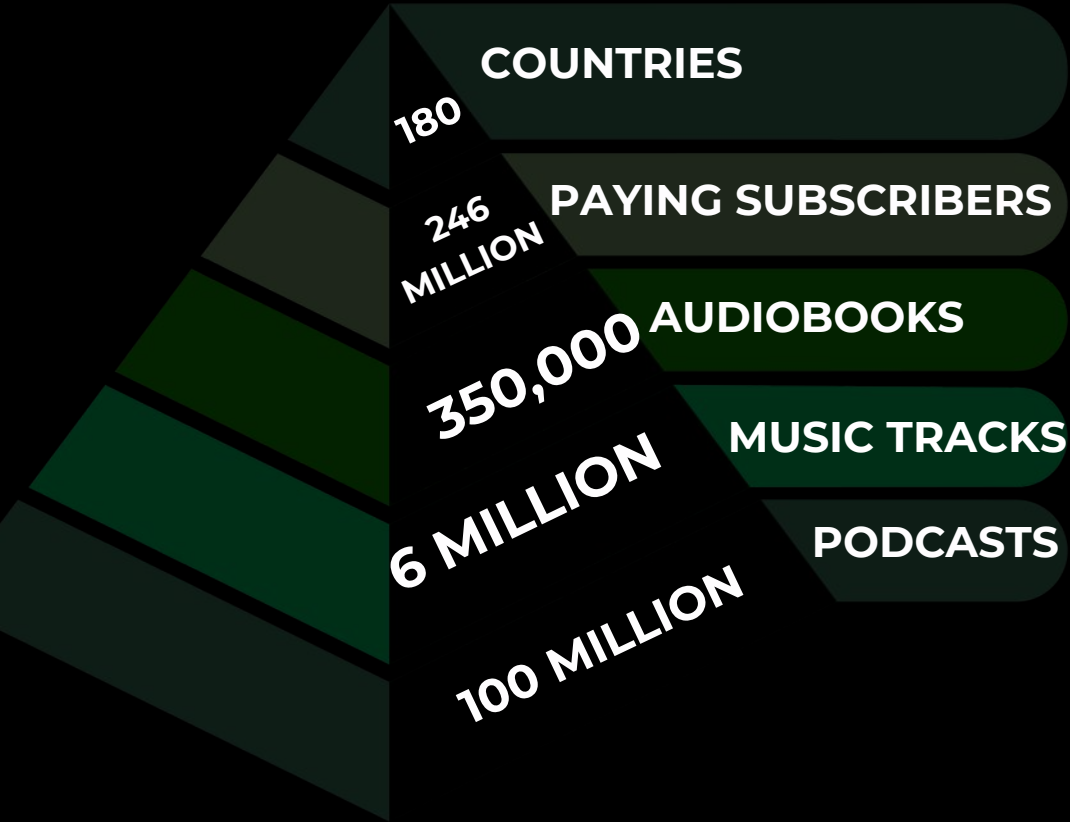
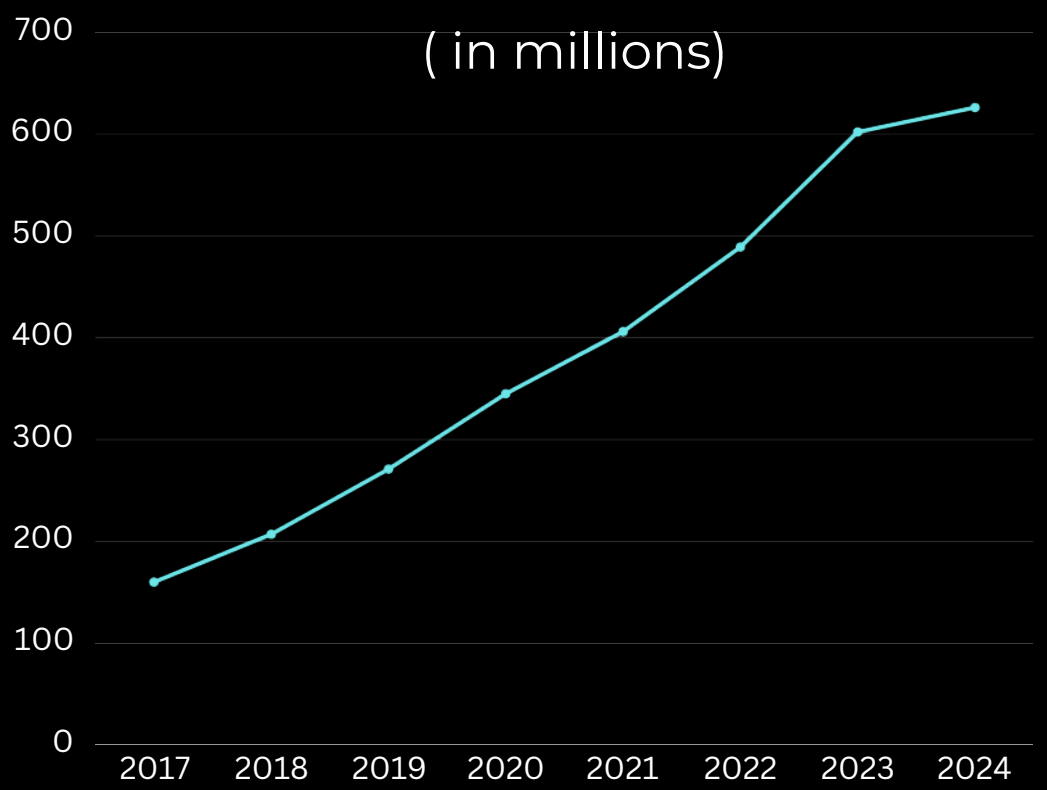
Note: Repeat listens for podcasts are <15%.

MARKET INSIGHTS

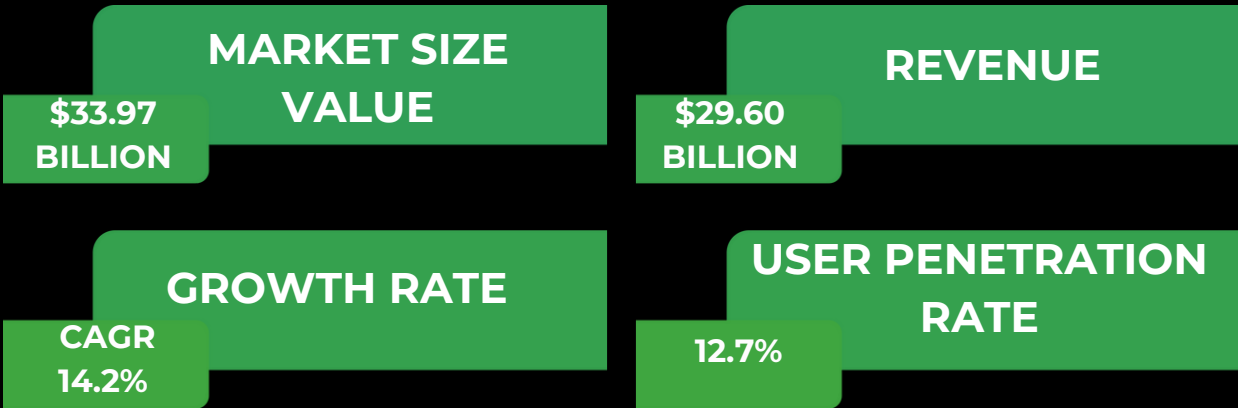
- Podcast market size: \$30B globally, growing at 22% CAGR.
- Short-form and highlights-based audio content seeing 45% YoY growth.
- 64% of listeners say they prefer personalized, bite-sized recommendations.



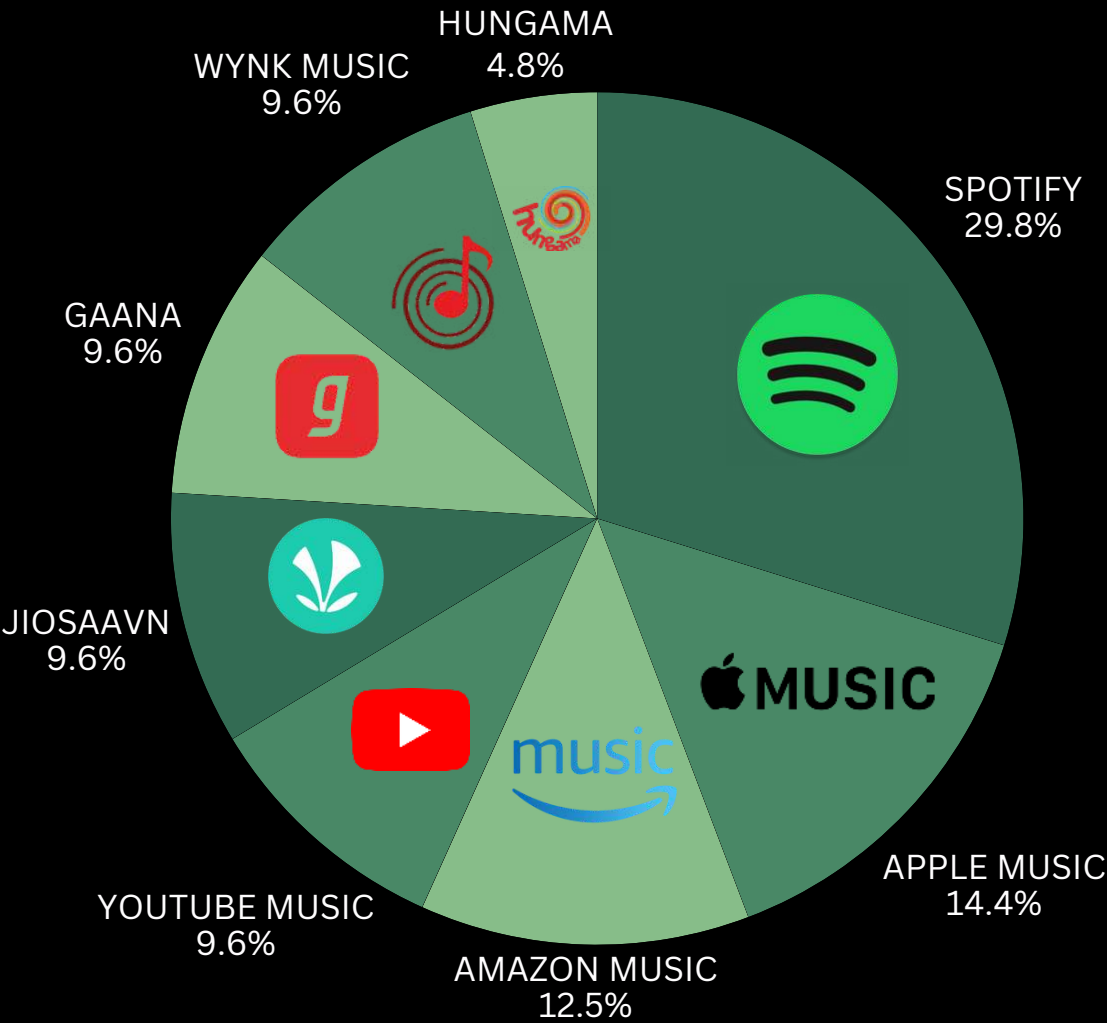
SPOTIFY MONTHLY USERS



INDUSTRY OVERVIEW

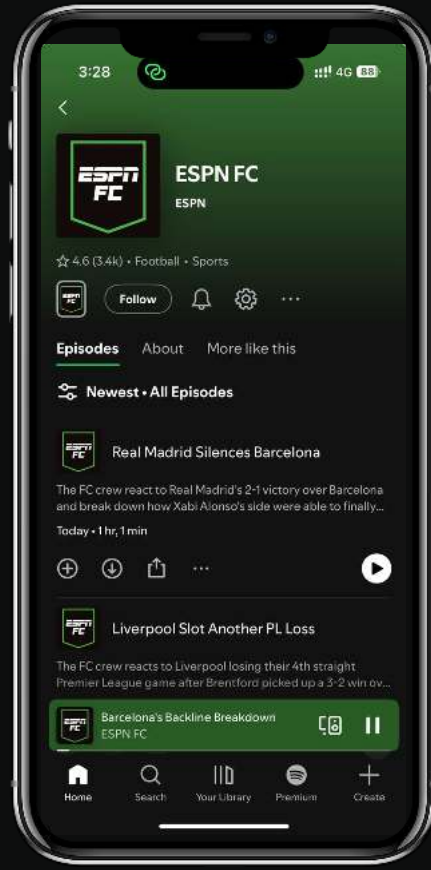
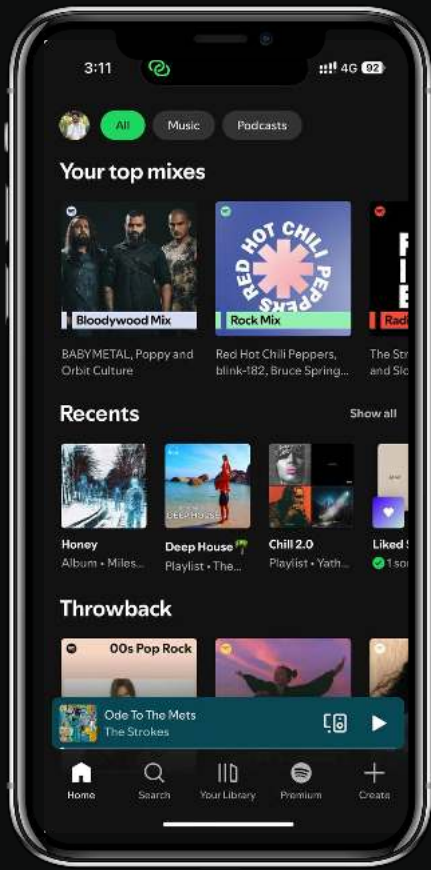


KEY PLAYERS

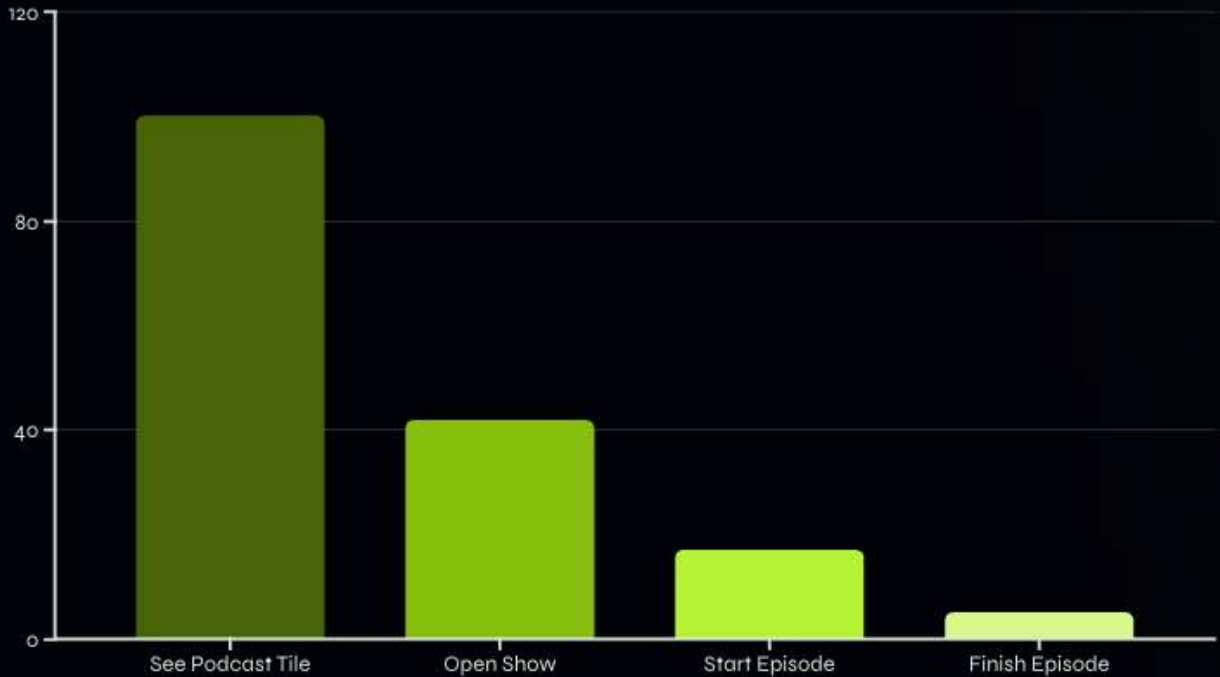


FEATURE ANALYSIS

Feature	Works Well	Needs Improvement
Home Feed	Great music personalization	Podcast visibility low
Podcast Pages	Good layout	No highlights, comments, or snippets
Search	Fast and accurate	Music dominates; weak podcast filters
Playback UI	Smooth & simple	No AI summaries or preview options
Playlists	High engagement for music	No podcast equivalents



USER DROP-OFF DATA

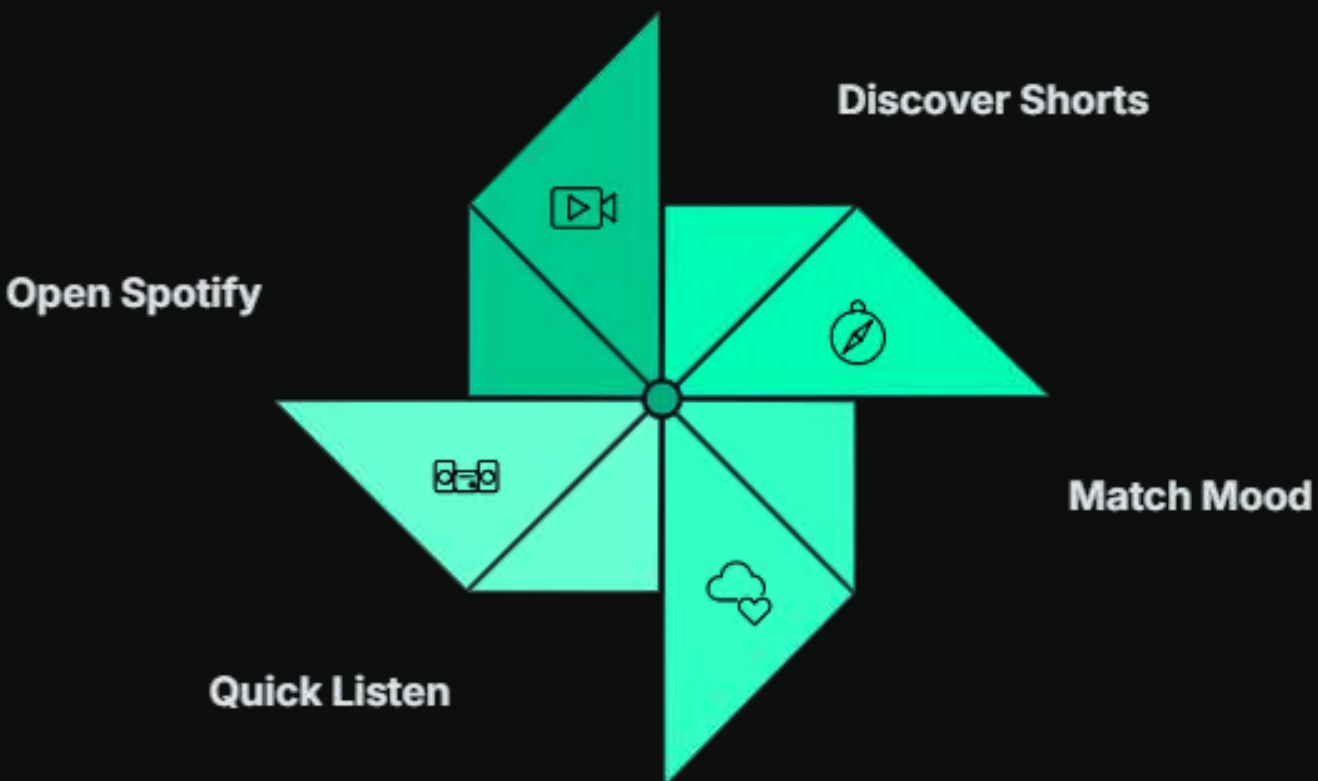
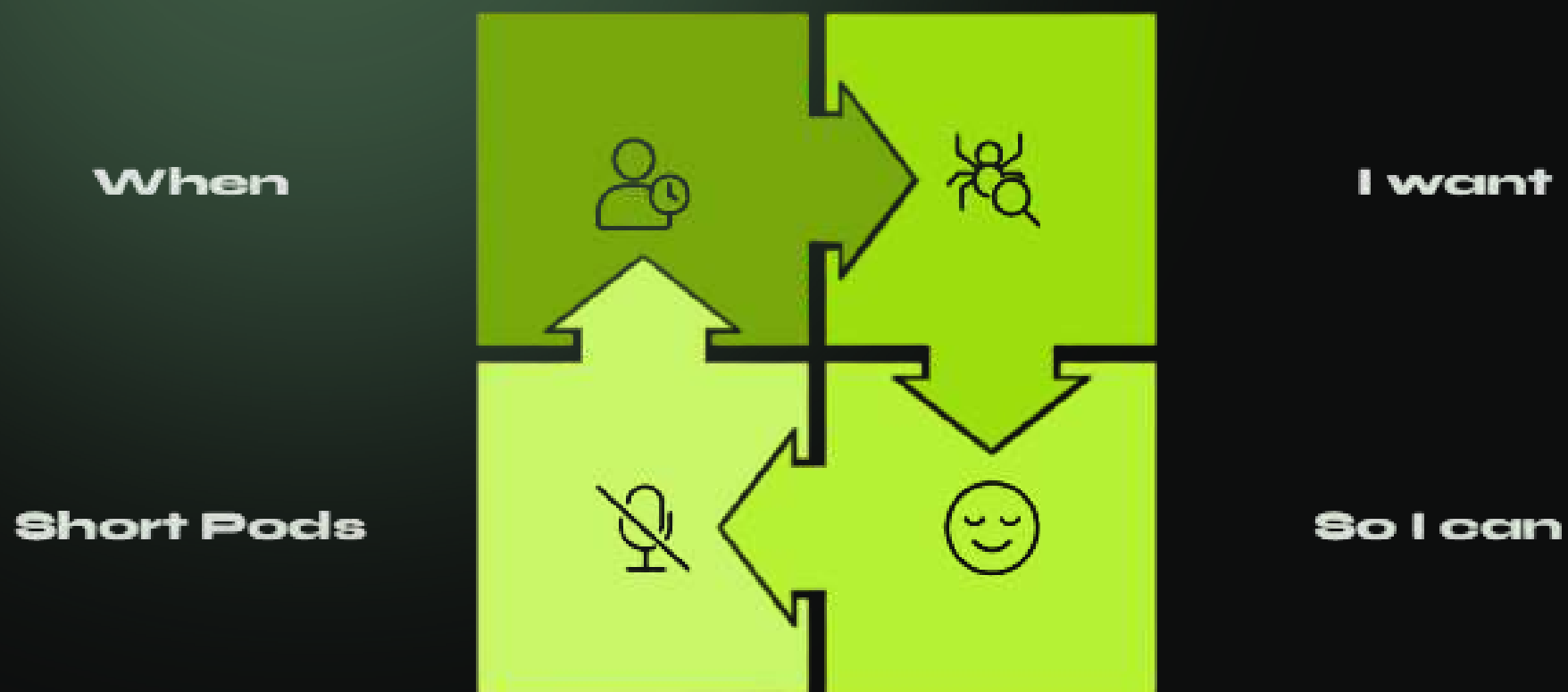


TOP DROP-OFF REASONS

- Podcast market size: \$30B globally, growing at 22% CAGR
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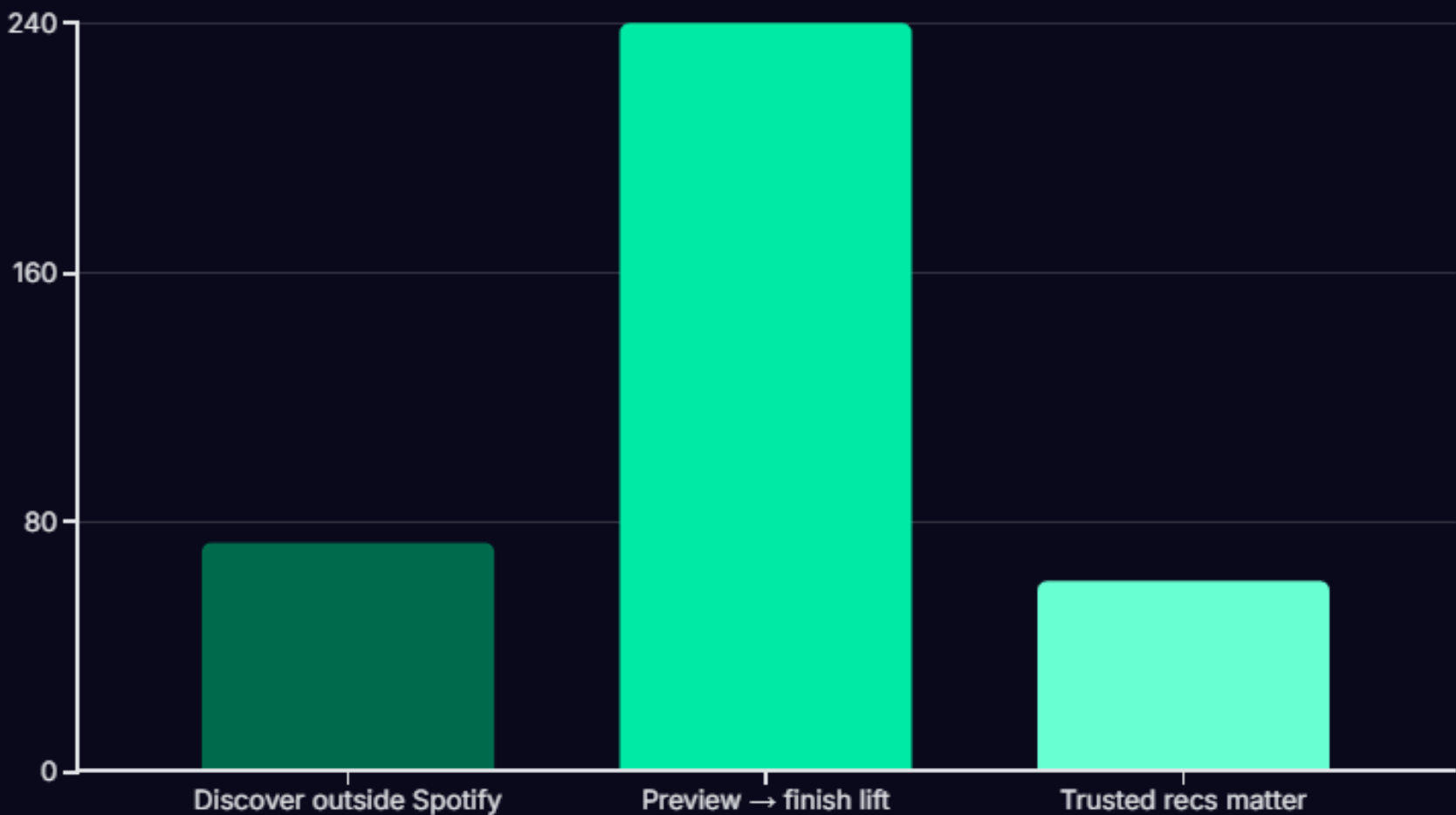


Problem Definition



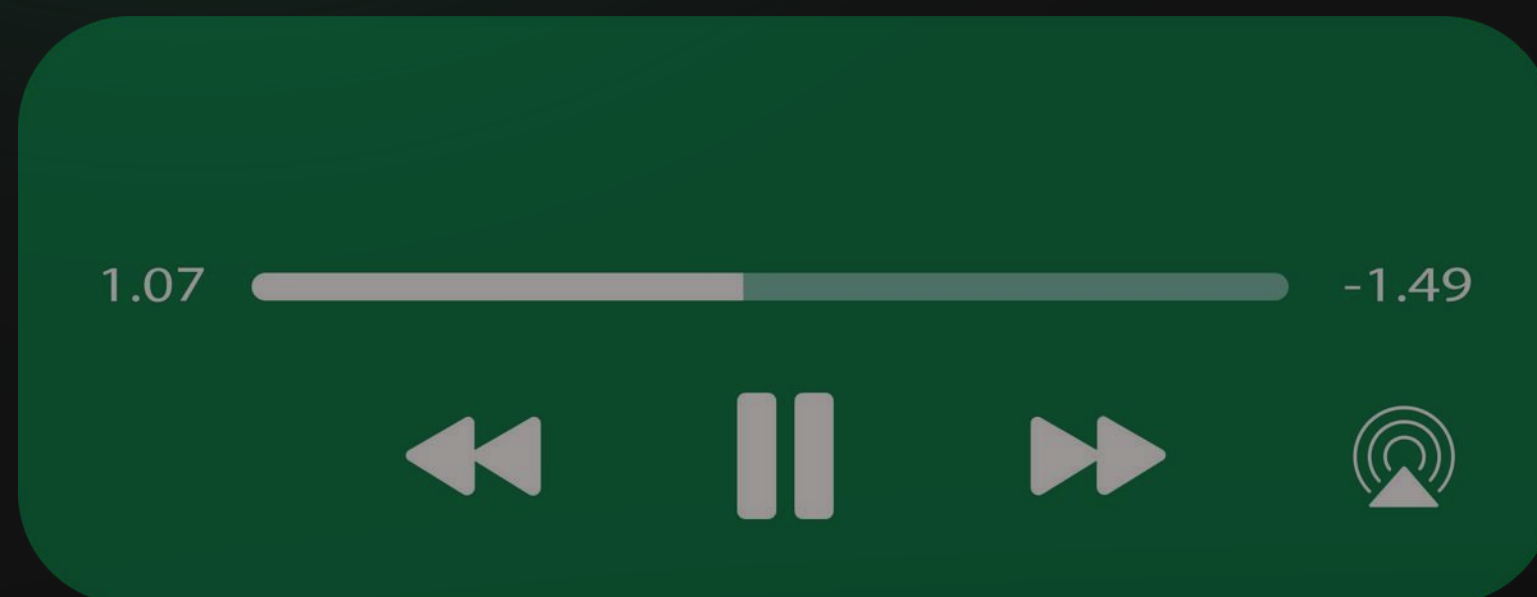
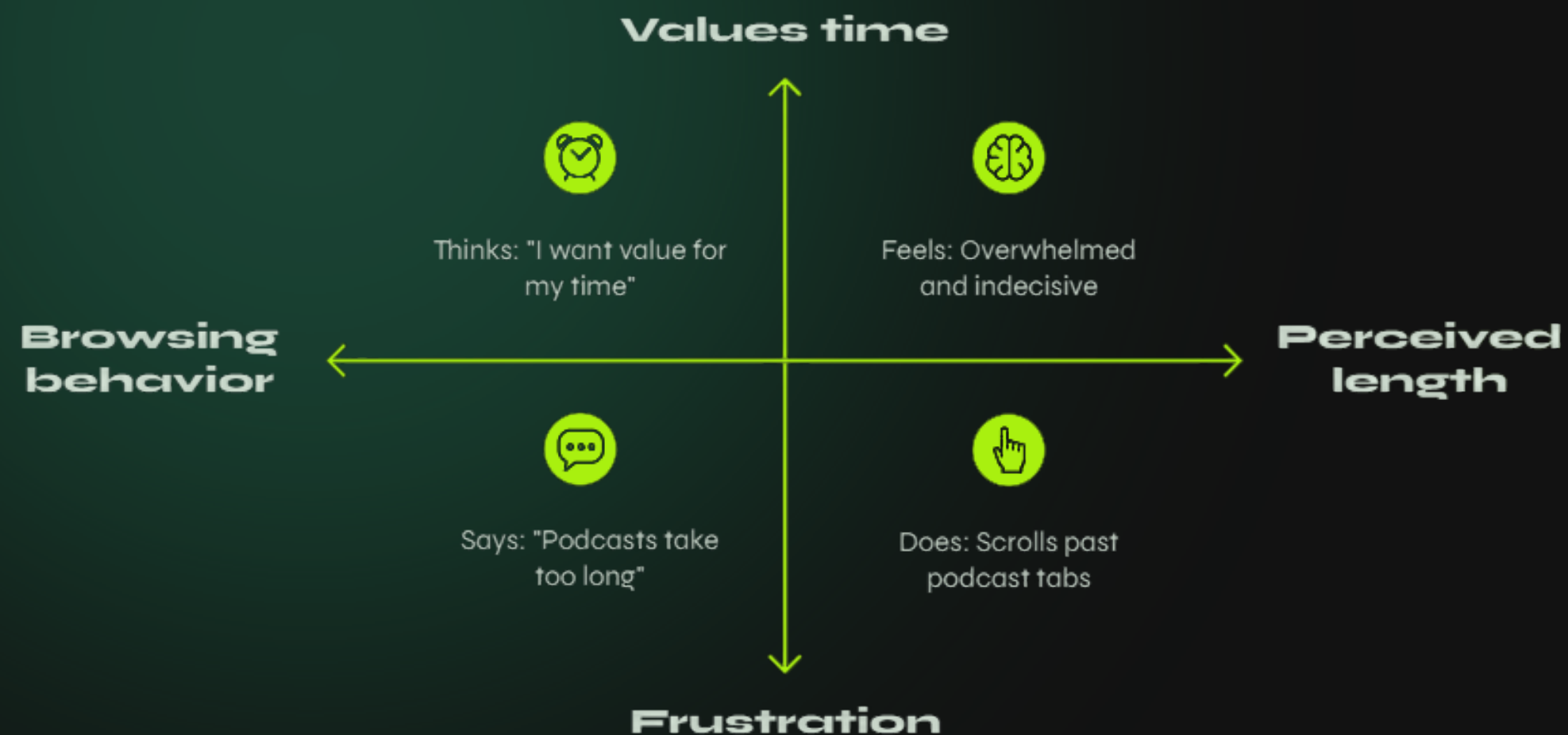
Problem Breakdown

- 1 Low discoverability**
Users can't find relevant podcasts fast.
- 2 High friction**
Long episodes; no highlights or previews.
- 3 Weak personalization**
Recommendations not dynamic or contextual.
- 4 Low engagement hooks**
No playlists, sharing, or creator-fan interactions.





User Personas & Empathy Map



Persona 1: "The Multitask Listener"

Profile

Age: 25–35 | Occupation: Young professional

Motivation: Learn or be entertained while commuting or multitasking

Pain Points

Behavior: Short attention span (~10 min avg. session)

Pain Points: Can't easily find quick, relevant content

"If I only have 10 minutes, I'll just play music."



Persona 2: "The Curious Explorer"

Profile

Age: 18–28 | Occupation: Student / Casual listener

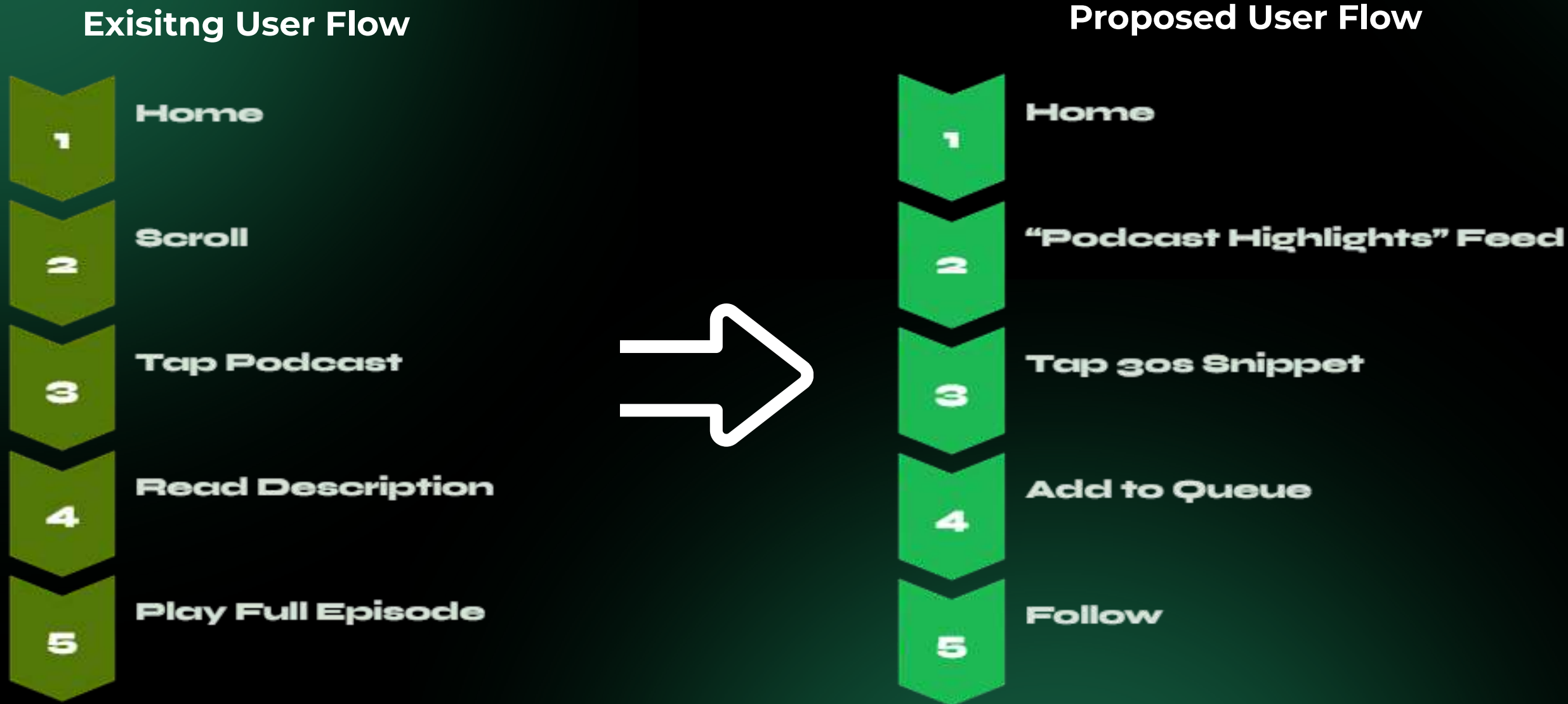
Motivation: Discover new creators or trending content

Pain Points

Behavior: Browses but rarely commits to full episodes

Pain Points: Overwhelmed by options; no trusted filtering

User Flows + Proposed Enhancements



Expected Improvements:

60%

Discovery Time Reduced

42%

Completion Rate Up

(from 26%)

18%

Follow Conversion Up

(from 6%)



PART 2: IDEATION, SOLUTIONING AND DESIGNS

Ideation and solutioning



Market Gaps Identified:

- **Discovery Gap:** Users can't easily find relevant podcasts
- **Engagement Gap:** Lack of short-form previews and social interactions
- **Personalization Gap:** Recommendations not dynamic or context-driven
- **Creator Gap:** Podcasters can't promote or highlight episodes effectively

Top User Pain Points:

- "Too many podcasts, no clear starting point."
- "Episodes are too long to sample."
- "I don't know what's trending in my interests."
- "I wish podcasts had playlists like songs."

Prioritized Market Gaps:

Discovery & Preview	High	Very High	High	★ Po
Personalization	High	High	Medium	★ Po
Social Engagement	Medium	Medium	Medium	Pi
Creator Tools	Medium	Medium	High	Pi

Top 3 Ideas:



AI Podcast Highlights Feed

Short audio/video previews of trending podcasts



Smart Contextual Recommendations

Time, mood, and routine-based suggestions



Social Listening & Fan Playlists

Allow users to share podcast clips and playlists

Feature Prioritization



Feature List:

- AI Podcast Highlights Feed
- Smart Playlists (e.g., "15-Min Commute Picks")
- Social Sharing & Activity Feed
- Friend Recommendations & Likes
- Creator Highlight Upload Tool
- Exclusive Barça Podcast Hub
- Podcast Ratings & Reviews
- In-App AI Summaries (episode TL;DR)

RICE Scoring Framework

Feature	Reach	Impact	Confidence	Effort	Score	Priority
AI Highlights Feed	8	9	8	4	144	Po
Smart Playlists	8	8	8	5	128	Po
Barça Podcast Hub	7	9	9	6	105	Po
AI Summaries	7	8	7	6	98	P1
Social Feed	6	7	7	6	84	P1
Creator Tools	5	7	8	5	80	P1
Ratings & Reviews	6	6	9	5	72	P2
Friend Recs	5	5	7	5	60	P2

Must-Have (Po)

- AI Highlights Feed
- Smart Playlists
- Barça Hub

Could-Have (P2)

- Ratings
- Friend Recs

Should-Have (P1)

- AI Summaries
- Social Feed
- Creator Tools

Won't-Have (Now)

- Offline sharing features

Designs & User Flow (with Prototype Overview)

New User Flow Comparison:



Designs & User Flow (with Prototype Overview)

Key Design Principles:

- Frictionless Discovery**
 Scrollable feed of 30–60s previews
- Contextual Entry Points**
 Time-of-day, location, and habit triggers
- Retention Hooks**
 Follow, share, and save buttons easily accessible



Prototype Concept (highlights feed):

- Auto-playing short clips with captions and progress ring
- Swipe up to follow or queue
- Similar design language to Spotify's "Discover Mode" or TikTok interface

Wireframe Overview:

- 01
Home Feed
 (with "Highlights" tab)
- 02
Snippet Player
 (mini preview)
- 03
Smart Playlist Page
 ("Commute Picks")
- 04
Barça Hub page
 (team logo, exclusive episodes)
- 05
AI Summary view
 (TL;DR section)

LAUNCH TARGET

Primary audience: 18–35 years old, urban listeners, podcast-curious users

Secondary audience: Football fans (via FC Barcelona partnership)

LAUNCH STRATEGY (0 TO 1)

- **Markets:** Spain, India, Brazil (Barça strongholds + high Spotify use)
- **Campaign:** "Hear What the World Is Talking About" – featuring podcast previews
- **Channels:** In-app banners, Spotify social channels, Barça app, YouTube Shorts
- **Partnership Activation:** Launch exclusive "Inside Barça" podcast with player guests

COMMUNITY & RETENTION LOOPS

- Incentivize engagement via badges ("Top Podcast Explorer")
- Offer creator dashboard to track listens
- Introduce "Share Snippet" feature for viral reach

GROWTH STRATEGY



Stage	Objective	Strategy
0 → 1	Validate engagement	Beta launch with FC Barcelona fanbase (100K users)
1 → 10	Drive organic adoption	AI snippet feed for top genres (sports, comedy, news)
10 → 100	Scale globally	Introduce creator tools & local language playlists



ENGAGEMENT METRICS

Metric	Baseline	Target	Description
Podcast Completion Rate	26%	40%	Avg. percentage of episode listened
Avg. Session Duration	18 min	25 min	Total listening time per session
Follow Rate per Episode	6%	18%	% of listeners who follow the show
Snippet-to-Play Conversion	9%	25%	% who listen to full episode after preview

DISCOVERY METRICS

Metric	Baseline	Target	Description
Discovery → Play Conversion	9%	20%	Users discovering & starting playback
New Podcast Try Rate	12%	25%	Listeners who try new podcasts weekly
Recommendations CTR	7%	15%	Clicks on AI suggestions or playlists

RETENTION & GROWTH METRICS



Metric	Baseline	Target
Monthly Active Podcast Listeners	+15% growth	+25% growth
Repeat Podcast Listeners	2.5M → 4.5M users	2.5M → 4.5M users
Fan-driven Engagement (Barça Hub)	300K → 800K monthly listens	300K → 800K monthly listens

QUALITATIVE METRICS

NPS Podcast Discovery
From +28 → +45

User Satisfaction (CSAT)
From 3.8/5 → +4.5/10

Creator Feedback Score
25% improvement post-launch



